

Week 01 Knowledge Check — TPM Academy

Week 1 Knowledge Check — Customer-Centric Foundations

A short retention check covering the week's core ideas: AI fundamentals & prompting, working backwards, personas, pain points, and problem framing. Answer each question, then check yourself against the key at the end. Aim for concepts, not trivia — every answer maps back to something we used in a lab.

Format: 12 questions (multiple choice + true/false). ~15 minutes. Individual or triad.

Questions

1. (MC) The RCCF prompting scaffold stands for:

- A. Role, Constraints, Context, Feedback
- B. Role, Context, Constraints, Format
- C. Request, Context, Criteria, Format
- D. Role, Content, Clarity, Format

2. (MC) You ask an AI to summarize your product's competitive landscape and it produces a confident, plausible-sounding answer that is generic and not actually about your product. Which failure mode is this most likely?

- A. Hallucination
- B. Sycophancy
- C. Context starvation
- D. Anchoring

3. (MC) Rank the evidence tiers from most to least trustworthy:

- A. Reported → Observed → Inferred → AI-generated
- B. Observed → Reported → Inferred → AI-generated
- C. Observed → Inferred → Reported → AI-generated
- D. AI-generated → Observed → Reported → Inferred

4. (T/F) A model with a good enough context window will remember facts about your product from previous, separate sessions even if you don't include them in the current prompt.

5. (MC) In a Working Backwards PR/FAQ, which section is described as the *single most diagnostic* — if it sounds like marketing, the idea is in trouble?

- A. The heading
- B. The problem paragraph
- C. The customer quote
- D. The summary paragraph

6. (T/F) The core purpose of the Working Backwards document is to plan *how* to build a product the team has already decided to build.

7. (MC) Which of the “Five Questions That Force Clarity” is where Day 1’s evidence tiers re-enter the picture?

- A. “Who is the customer?”
- B. “What is the most important benefit?”
- C. “How do you know what they want or need?”
- D. “What does the experience look like?”

8. (T/F) Writing a persona trait as an adjective — e.g., “busy,” “tech-savvy” — is a strength because it captures the customer succinctly.

9. (MC) During a validation interview, which question should you **avoid** asking?

- A. “Walk me through the last time you did X.”
- B. “Would you use a product that did X?”
- C. “What did you do to work around it?”
- D. “How often does that happen?”

10. (MC) According to the pain-extraction sources, where does the *most reliable* signal of real pain usually show up?

- A. Support tickets
- B. Observation / ride-alongs (workarounds, side-channels)
- C. Sales/loss reviews
- D. Analytics drop-offs

11. (MC) In the Severity × Frequency × Addressability model, which axis do PMs most often forget — and which turns a pain into a *communication* problem rather than a product one when it's low?

- A. Severity
- B. Frequency
- C. Addressability
- D. Reliability

12. (T/F) The line most problem statements skip — and the one that lets you know when you're actually done — is “Success looks like...”

Answer Key

- 1. B** — Role, Context, Constraints, Format. The kernel prompt scaffold; heavier frameworks (CO-STAR, CRISPE) are elaborations of the same habit.
- 2. C** — Context starvation: a plausible-but-generic answer. Fix by adding Role + Context and pasting in the source material. (Hallucination is *confident fabricated specifics*; this one is generic.)
- 3. B** — Observed → Reported → Inferred → AI-generated. AI-generated is the lowest tier and must be upgraded before use.
- 4. False** — If the model can't see it in the prompt, it's guessing. "What does this model know about my product right now? Nothing."
- 5. C** — The customer quote. If you can't write a fictional-but-credible quote believably, the PR fails; if it sounds like marketing, the problem is marketing.
- 6. False** — Working Backwards is used to decide *whether* to build at all, not to plan the how of an already-approved build. "Fiction you can stress-test is cheaper than code you can't unship."
- 7. C** — "How do you know what they want or need?" — name the evidence and tag its tier.
- 8. False** — Adjectives are the real killer because they're un-falsifiable. Working personas use observed behaviors and words, each tied to an evidence tier.
- 9. B** — "Would you use a product that did X?" The answer is always yes. Ask about past behavior instead (the "Mom Test" instinct).
- 10. B** — Observation / ride-alongs are highest for real pain. The best pain points are the ones customers *stopped* complaining about because they built a workaround.
- 11. C** — Addressability. High severity + high frequency + low addressability = communicate, don't engineer. A red "Must fix" cell is a stakeholder-framing problem, not a JIRA ticket.
- 12. True** — "Success looks like..." is the most-skipped line and the one that makes a problem statement falsifiable.